

PREPARED FOR CIAN COLLINS, NOVA HCM

Build the Nova HCM marketing team you never had

An agent-led marketing system, built for Nova HCM and handed over. First the brand strategy, decoded into code, which becomes the DNA everything else runs on. Then the parts of the system that run on it: outbound agents to bring pipeline in, a new website, and a ghostwriter. Then Vanessa trained to run all of it.



Quality first, then automate



IRELAND'S MARKETER OF THE YEAR, 2022

Before I build anything, I ask one question: what does really good look like here? Not what AI can do, but the best version of this marketing, and the level of quality I would want to stand over.

So I start where I always have. If there were no AI at all, what team would I hire to do this properly? A strategist to set the positioning and the plan, someone doing the outreach one company at a time, a designer and a developer for the website, and a writer building your authority in public. I map that team first, then build exactly it, with agents instead of hires.

Twenty years in brand is what tells me where the bar sits: Head of Brand at 02 Ireland, then CMO at the National Lottery, Head of Brand at Indeed and Miro, both global roles. Positioning, messaging and tone are written first, then built into everything the agents make.

WHO I WORK WITH

Moloco

Heineken

Norcros

Alltech

Smurfit

Hostelworld

Eaton Square

Weatherbys

"His command of marketing science as well as his instincts for great thinking and ideas are, in my opinion, superb."

Peter Field · The Godfather of Effectiveness, author of The Long and the Short of It

"Paul reported into me as Head of Brand when I was at Indeed. I have learned more from him than anyone else in my career."

Paul D'Arcy · CMO, Moloco. Former CMO at Miro and Indeed

What we would build for Nova HCM

This comes from our conversation. We would deliver an agent-led marketing system. A set of agents that do the marketing work, all of them running on one agreed strategy, so that everything they produce is on brand and on message without anyone having to check it. Below is what is in the system and the order we would build it in.

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- 01 **Brand strategy, decoded into code.** The positioning, the key target audiences, the key pain points, the key messages, the tone of voice and the brand identity. We work it out together and write it down in one place, then decode it into a file the website is built from and every agent writes against. That file becomes the DNA of all Nova's marketing communications. This is where most of the work goes and everything else depends on it.
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- 02 **Outbound agents, on email and LinkedIn.** The job of finding the companies worth approaching, finding the HR leader in each one, researching the company and writing to that person. The agent does the whole job and writes each message separately, using the brand strategy every time. Ireland and the US are handled differently because the law is different: Irish contacts are emailed one at a time from Cian's own mailbox, US contacts can be emailed in volume. Nothing goes out until you approve it.
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- 03 **A new website.** Designed and built through Claude Code in React and hosted on Vercel, running the same brand strategy so the messaging turns up throughout it. Once it is built this way, Vanessa can change it by asking rather than raising a job. That turns the site from something that sits there into the page your outbound sends people to.
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- 04 **A ghostwriter and social agent.** Takes what you already say, from a voice note or a recording of a talk, and turns it into LinkedIn posts, articles for the website and short video clips, in your voice. It runs your positioning every time and it runs on a cadence, which is the part you said you struggle with. You do not have to write anything.
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- 05 **Vanessa trained to run it.** The last part of the work is Vanessa doing each job herself: publishing an article, running an outbound batch from approval through to send, and changing something on the website. If she can do all three on her own, the handover is done.
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The parts, and what each one is for

DELIVERABLE ONE

Brand strategy, decoded into code

The first thing we would deliver is the brand strategy. That is the positioning, the key target audiences, the key pain points, the key messages, the tone of voice and the brand identity. We work all of it out together and write it down properly in one place.

It is then decoded into code. Not a document that gets read once and filed, but a file that the website is built from and that every agent writes against. That file becomes the DNA of all Nova's marketing communications.

This is where most of the work goes, and everything else in the system depends on it. Once it is locked in, a LinkedIn post, a cold email and a page on the site all carry the same positioning and the same voice, because they are all produced from the same source. That is what lets the rest of the system run at speed without the quality dropping.

Related reading: [The 95:5 rule, the day-one list](#) · [What is mental availability](#)

DELIVERABLE TWO

The outbound agents

Outbound is a job a person does. Someone has to pick the companies worth approaching, find the HR leader in each one, research the company, and write to that person. Doing it properly at any scale has needed a full-time hire, an agency, or a freelancer. Most outbound ends up as a template with a few fields swapped in. The agent does the whole job and writes each message separately.

The agent builds the target list rather than buying one: mid-market employers of five hundred to five thousand staff, in the sectors Nova already works in. It researches the company and the person, then writes an opening from that research. There are three approval points: the companies and roles, the messages, and the send. Nothing goes out and nothing is spent until you approve it.

Ireland and the US are handled differently because the law is different. Irish contacts are emailed one at a time from Cian's own mailbox, which keeps that side GDPR compliant. US contacts can be emailed in volume. That distinction is built into the agent so the compliant route is the default.

DELIVERABLE THREE

The website

Building a website has needed a designer, a front end developer and someone to manage both. We do that work with AI. Rather than describe it, the web version of this proposal has Nova rebuilt from your current site, so you can judge the speed for yourself. To be clear about what it is: it was produced in minutes with no brief, working only from the content already on novahcm.ie. It shows what is technically possible, not how your site would look. The design would come out of the brand strategy, with a proper brief, the right photography, agreed navigation and written content. The more useful point is that once a site is built this way you can produce a page for a single company you are about to approach, so someone arriving from an outbound message lands on something written for them.

Two issues came up while building it, and both are worth fixing either way. Your DMARC record is set to p=none, which means it reports mail that fails authentication without asking anyone to act on it. Your SPF is already strict, so the next step is to read a few weeks of reports, then move to quarantine, then reject. Worth doing before any new outreach goes out. And novahcm.ie/sitemap.xml returns a 404 while robots.txt is an empty file, so search engines are not being told which pages exist and which matter.

Related reading: [Dump your website and start again](#)

DELIVERABLE FOUR

The ghostwriter and social agent

For an HR leader to know Nova before they start looking for a system, someone has to publish regularly and publish something worth reading. That has meant hiring a content person, an agency or a freelancer. None of

those work well here. You know the market and have no time to write. Writers with the time do not know the market.

You already produce the material. You speak at UNLEASH and the HR technology shows, you ran a two hour workshop with fifteen people last week, and you run diagnostic calls most weeks. None of it gets written down. The agent takes what you already say, from a voice note or a recording of a talk, and turns it into LinkedIn posts, articles for the website and short video clips, in your voice. It runs your positioning every time and it runs on a cadence. Nothing is invented, no client is named without their written agreement, and you approve every piece before it goes out.

Related reading: [How I build an AI writer](#)

DELIVERABLE FIVE

Handover to Vanessa

You said you needed someone to help build the system so you could enable someone like Vanessa. She does not need to become a marketer. Running it should be a few tasks in her week.

Buying the same capability the traditional way means four people: one on the website, one on outbound, one writing, and one on social. This puts it into a system your operations lead runs alongside her existing job. Nova owns it outright, which matters given you are building the business to sell.

Two options

Option A is the whole build: the brand strategy, the outbound agents, the website, the ghostwriter, and Vanessa trained to run it. Option B is the same build with me on the team for three months afterwards, working on Nova's marketing each month and building more of the system as you need it. We would recommend starting with Option A, because the point is that Nova owns and runs this. If you would rather have me involved while it beds in, Option B does that, and you can also add it on later.

OPTION A

The build, handed over

- › Brand strategy: positioning, key target audiences, key pain points, key messages, tone of voice and brand identity, decoded into the code the whole system runs on
- › The outbound agents on email and LinkedIn, with the Irish and US lanes built to their different legal requirements
- › A new website, built in React through Claude Code and hosted on Vercel, which Vanessa can change by asking
- › The ghostwriter, turning what you already say into LinkedIn posts, articles and short video clips, running on a cadence
- › Everything configured for Nova, handed over, and Vanessa trained until she runs each part unaided

€15,000 plus VAT

Two months from sign-off, front-loaded so the positioning and the website are live before you speak in September. Your own tool subscriptions are separate, in your name, sized with you first.

OPTION B

The build, and me on the team afterwards

- › Everything in Option A
- › **Marketing leadership every month.** Time spent working on Nova's marketing with you: what to promote and how, what is working, what to change, and what to do next
- › **More of the system built.** An email marketing agent, a CRM to hold the pipeline as it grows, or whatever the next useful part turns out to be
- › **Continued training** for Vanessa and anyone else on the team as new parts are added
- › **Direct access to me between sessions**, not only on the scheduled ones
- › You can stop the monthly at any point

€24,000 plus VAT

€15,000 build, then €3,000/month × 3 months = €24,000. The HR system comparison engine you described, the moneysupermarket idea, is a separate build and would be scoped on its own once the rest is in place.

WHAT THE PRICE COVERS

The strategy work, the build, the handover, and training your team to run it. I do the building myself and hand the system over, so Run with Foxes does not have to become a permanent cost. If you do want me to stay involved, that is Option B rather than something you are locked into. From your side it needs a half day at the start on the positioning, about an hour a week after that, and a couple of recorded sessions for the ghostwriter to work from.

WHAT IT DOESN'T

Your own tool subscriptions, in your name: Claude Code, hosting, an email platform and the data the outbound agent uses. A small, predictable software bill, agreed with you before anything is spent.

Book a time to chat

Thirty minutes is enough to talk it through. Book a time at cal.com/paul-dervan-mjfd50, or email me directly at paul@runwithfoxes.com.